

The Miser

A **miser bundled up** all the things he **possessed** and sold them at the market. With the money he got, he bought a huge **bar** of gold. Fearing for its safety, the miser **dug** a hole in his **backyard** and buried it. Everyday, before anyone could **wake up**, the miser would go to the spot where he had buried the gold bar, dig it out and **gaze** at it.

Days passed. One day, one of his workers arrived for work early and was surprised to see the miser in the garden with a **spade** in hand. He **hid** behind a **bush** and watched the miser digging out the bar of gold.

"Wow!" thought the worker, his eyes **popping out** in **wonder**. "If I could get hold of that gold, I wouldn't have to work for the rest of my life."

He waited for Sunday as that was the only day the miser went to church, and **stealthily** dug out the gold.

The next morning when the miser went as usual to look at his gold, he got the shock of his life when he didn't find it.

"**Woe** is me!" he **lamented** loudly, **overcome** with **grief**. "I have lost everything!"

A neighbour hearing the miser **moan**, went up to him and said, "I have a suggestion."

"Suggestion?" asked the man. "Will it help me get back the gold?"

"No," said the neighbour. "But it will bring you the same **pleasure** you **derived** from the gold."

The miser was puzzled. "How is that possible?"

"Quite simple," said the neighbour. "Take a stone of the same size as the gold and bury it at the spot where you'd buried the gold."

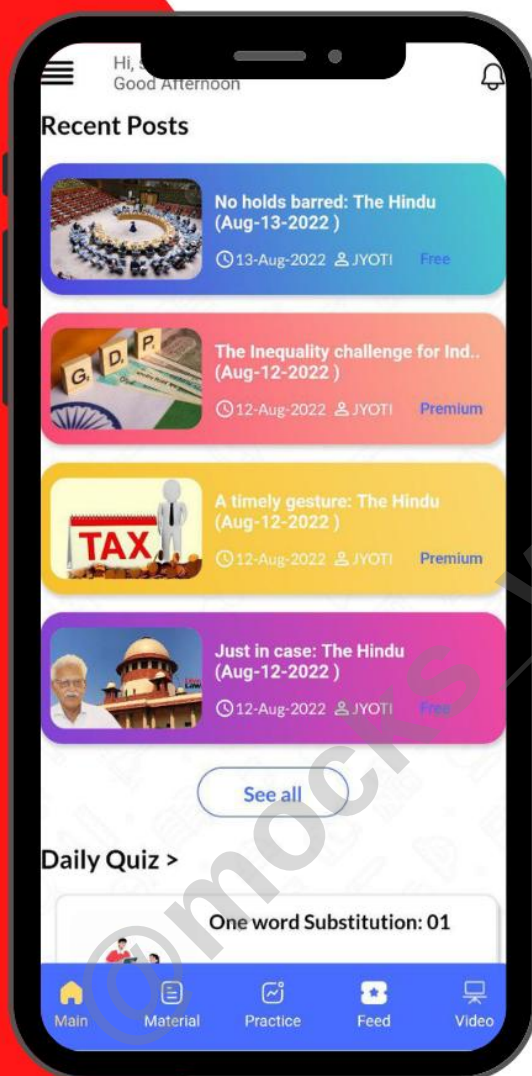
"And pray, how will that help?" asked the miser, even more **bewildered**.

"When you had the gold, you were happy just to look at it. You did not want to use it," replied the neighbour. "You can derive the same happiness now by looking at the stone everyday!"



Vocabulary

1. **Miser** (noun) – hoarder, skinflint, penny-pincher, cheapskate, tightwad कंजूस व्यक्ति
2. **Bundle up** (phrasal verb) – pack, gather, tie up, wrap, assemble सामान समेटना / लपेटना
3. **Possess** (verb) – own, hold, retain, acquire, occupy स्वामित्व रखना
4. **Bar** (noun) – block, lump, chunk, slab, ingot छड़ / धातु का टुकड़ा
5. **Dig** (verb) – excavate, unearth, burrow, scoop, shovel खोदना
6. **Backyard** (noun) – garden, yard, courtyard, lawn, enclosure पिछवाड़ा
7. **Wake up** (phrasal verb) – get up, arise, awaken, stir, rouse जागना
8. **Gaze** (at) (verb) – stare, look, peer, watch, observe टकटकी लगाकर देखना
9. **Spade** (noun) – shovel, hoe, digger, scoop, mattock फावड़ा
10. **Hide** (verb) – conceal, cover, secrete, stash, veil छिपाना
11. **Bush** (noun) – shrub, hedge, undergrowth, thicket, brush झाड़ी
12. **Pop out** (phrasal verb) – bulge, protrude, emerge, spring out, stick out अचानक निकल आना
13. **Wonder** (noun) – amazement, awe, admiration, astonishment, marvel आश्चर्य
14. **Stealthily** (adverb) – secretly, quietly, sneakily, silently, covertly चुपके से
15. **Woe** (noun) – sorrow, misery, grief, anguish, despair विपत्ति / दुःख
16. **Lament** (verb) – mourn, grieve, bemoan, bewail, deplore विलाप करना
17. **Overcome** (verb) – overwhelm, overpower, subdue, defeat, engulf काबू पाना
18. **Grief** (noun) – sorrow, sadness, anguish, heartbreak, lamentation शोक / दुःख
19. **Moan** (verb) – groan, wail, cry, complain, lament कराहना / विलाप करना
20. **Pleasure** (noun) – joy, delight, happiness, satisfaction, bliss सुख / आनंद
21. **Derive** (verb) – obtain, extract, acquire, gain, receive प्राप्त करना
22. **Bewildered** (adjective) – confused, puzzled, perplexed, baffled, dazed हक्का-बक्का / भ्रमित



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